

6.2 Burst Modes

The burst shooting mode is also known as Continuous shooting mode. This is available on most cameras. This mode lets you take multiple shots without having to repeatedly click.

Using these modes is simple. In the shooting mode, set the camera to either Burst or Continuous mode. Now to click the photos, simply hold the shutter release and don't release it till you get the right shot. All the images will be stored on the memory card like normal photos.

Burst modes on most cameras are not unlimited. The performance of the burst mode varies from camera to camera. The burst mode shooting capabilities are usually described as frames per second. For example, 3 fps means that the camera can capture 3 images per second. The other number mentioned with this specification is the total number of images that can be captured all in one go.

The burst mode is great for high action scenarios like a car race or a fast soccer game where there is too much activity. Here, you can take a sequence of photos and later choose the best from them.

Limitations of burst mode shooting

Although the burst mode aids in getting a better photo, there are a few disadvantages as well.

First, there are several photos generated at once. This only adds to the confusion and managing these photos is a nightmare. If you have a camera with a mechanical shutter, then burst shots can be damaging in the long run.

With numerous photos being shot, you also waste a lot of memory space. With memory cards for cameras also fairly limited, wasting memory is not an option.

One of the other problems faced with burst mode is the use of flash and also exposure settings used. Sometimes, the flash takes long to recharge, so a burst sequence might be too short for the camera to charge the flash before the next shot.

The problem with shutter speeds is also similar. If the current lighting isn't sufficient for a good shot, then one of the ways used to increase exposure is to increase the shutter speed. If the shutter speed is greater than a certain value,